

Interrupted growth: On economic activity, climate-related events

Industrial growth is still tied to government spends on **infrastructure**

The Index of Industrial Production (IIP), the nation's monthly **barometer** of goods output, **revealed** a 10-month low growth rate in June, at 1.5%, largely due to the **sharp contraction** in mining activity, by -8.7% (10.3% in June 2024), and electricity output, by -2.6% (8.6% in June 2024). The early **onset** of the southwest monsoon, with its **erratic** and **uneven** distribution, **led to water logging** in large parts of the mining **belts** in Odisha, Jharkhand and West Bengal, **hampering** a key economic activity. Ranchi's regional **meteorological** office has said that Jharkhand recorded 504.8 mm (against a normal of 307 mm) between June 1 and July 12 — but five districts were **categorised** as rain **deficient**. The **resultant damage** to the power distribution infrastructure and **disruptions** to supply chains **may** have contributed to the **sluggish** growth in industrial output at 3.9% in June, up from 3.5% a year ago. This **in turn**, is **likely** to have led to **subdued** power demand. While mining and power production collectively **make up for** almost a quarter (22.3%) of the IIP's **weightage**, the rest is **apportioned** for manufacturing activities. The **robust growth** in capital (3.5%), intermediate (5.5%) and infrastructure (7.2%) goods output, **indicates** that much of industrial growth continues to **hinge on** the government's infrastructure spends.

There has been a general **reluctance**, both institutionally and in public economic **discourse** in India, to **explicitly correlate** disruptions in economic activity with climate-related events, especially in official **narratives** such as the IIP or GDP data releases. The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation and the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) **tend to** frame industrial and economic under-performance in terms of 'high base effects; supply chain **bottlenecks**; input cost **fluctuations**; global demand **softening**; and domestic consumption contraction'. Climate-related **disruptions**, such as in mining belts, **are** rarely mentioned in IIP or national accounts **commentary**. Economic data agencies in India have been slow to **integrate** climate risk frameworks into routine **macroeconomic** reporting, **unlike** institutions such as the European Central Bank or the Bank of England which have begun **mapping** climate risk to output and financial **stability**. True, climate attribution is complex: linking a specific event such as **waterlogging** in a coal mine to broader climate change involves scientific **rigour** and **probabilistic** modelling. **Policymakers often** avoid this due to fear of **politicising** economic data. **Indeed**, the RBI's Financial Stability Reports now include climate-related risks. But this has not yet filtered into production-side **metrics** such as the IIP. The time has come for India to make a systemic shift to integrate climate **attribution** to economic activity.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denote 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

1. **Infrastructure** (noun) – framework, facilities, foundation, base, support
आधारभूत संरचना
2. **Barometer** (noun) – gauge, indicator, measure, standard, benchmark सूचक
3. **Sharp** (adjective) – intense, acute, sudden, drastic, severe तीव्र
4. **Contraction** (noun) – reduction, shrinkage, decline, cutback, compression कमी
5. **Onset** (noun) – beginning, start, arrival, advent, commencement आरंभ
6. **Erratic** (adjective) – unpredictable, inconsistent, irregular, unstable, fluctuating अस्थिर
7. **Uneven** (adjective) – irregular, patchy, inconsistent, erratic, lopsided असमान
8. **Lead** (to) (verb) – cause, result in, bring about, produce, prompt कारण बनना
9. **Waterlogging** (noun) – flooding, submersion, saturation, inundation, soaking जलभराव
10. **Belt** (noun) – zone, region, area, stretch, strip क्षेत्र
11. **Hamper** (verb) – hinder, obstruct, impede, delay, restrict बाधित करना
12. **Meteorological** (adjective) – climatic, weather-related, atmospheric, forecasting, synoptic मौसम संबंधी
13. **Categorise** (verb) – classify, group, label, sort, arrange वर्गीकृत करना
14. **Deficient** (adjective) – lacking, insufficient, inadequate, scarce, meagre कमीग्रस्त
15. **Resultant** (adjective) – resulting, consequent, ensuing, subsequent परिणामी
16. **Disruption** (noun) – disturbance, interruption, breakdown, disorder, dislocation विघटन
17. **Sluggish** (adjective) – slow, lethargic, inactive, dull, stagnant सुस्त
18. **In turn** (phrase) – consequently, as a result, subsequently, hence, therefore फलस्वरूप
19. **Likely** (adjective) – probable, expected, plausible, foreseeable, possible संभावित
20. **Subdued** (adjective) – restrained, muted, low, soft, quiet मंद
21. **Make up for** (phrase) – compensate, offset, balance, redress, atone भरपाई करना
22. **Weightage** (noun) – significance, importance, value, emphasis, priority महत्व

23. **Apportion** (verb) – allocate, distribute, assign, divide, share बांटना
24. **Robust** (adjective) – strong, healthy, sturdy, vigorous, resilient मजबूत
25. **Hinge** (on) (verb) – depend, rely, rest, revolve, be contingent निर्भर होना
26. **Reluctance** (noun) – unwillingness, hesitation, disinclination, resistance, aversion अनिच्छा
27. **Discourse** (noun) – discussion, debate, conversation, dialogue, exchange विमर्श
28. **Explicitly** (adverb) – clearly, plainly, directly, openly, unequivocally स्पष्ट रूप से
29. **Correlate** (verb) – connect, associate, link, relate, tie सहसंबंधित करना
30. **Narrative** (noun) – story, account, chronicle, description, explanation वर्णन
31. **Tend** (to) (verb) – incline, be likely, gravitate, lean, be prone झुकाव होना
32. **Bottleneck** (noun) – obstruction, hindrance, blockage, choke point, jam अड़चन
33. **Fluctuation** (noun) – variation, instability, shift, swing, oscillation उतार-चढ़ाव
34. **Softening** (noun) – easing, weakening, relaxation, decline, moderation नरमी
35. **Commentary** (noun) – analysis, explanation, annotation, observation, review टीका
36. **Integrate** (verb) – combine, incorporate, unify, merge, blend समाहित करना
37. **Macroeconomic** (adjective) – large-scale economic, national-economic, broad-economic, fiscal, aggregate व्यापक आर्थिक
38. **Unlike** (preposition) – different from, dissimilar to, in contrast to, opposed to, contrary to भिन्न
39. **Map** (verb) – chart, plot, diagram, represent, outline चित्रित करना
40. **Stability** (noun) – steadiness, firmness, security, balance, constancy स्थिरता
41. **Rigour** (noun) – strictness, severity, exactness, precision, discipline कठोरता
42. **Probabilistic** (adjective) – statistical, likely, stochastic, chance-based, possibility-oriented संभाव्य
43. **Policymaker** (noun) – legislator, decision-maker, planner, regulator, authority नीति निर्माता
44. **Often** (adverb) – frequently, regularly, repeatedly, commonly, usually अक्सर
45. **Politicise** (verb) – make political, exploit, manipulate, dramatize, publicize राजनीतिक रंग देना

46. **Indeed** (adverb) – truly, certainly, actually, undoubtedly, surely वास्तव में

47. **Metric** (noun) – measure, standard, benchmark, indicator, criterion मापदंड

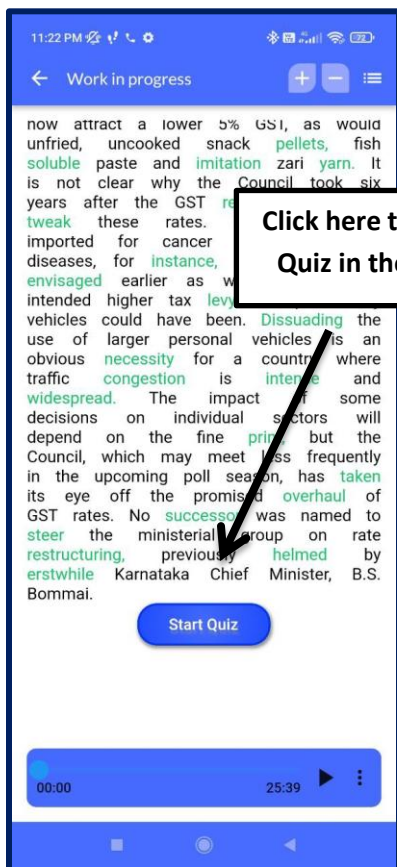
48. **Attribution** (noun) – the action of regarding something as being caused by a person or thing. आरोपण

@mocks_wallah

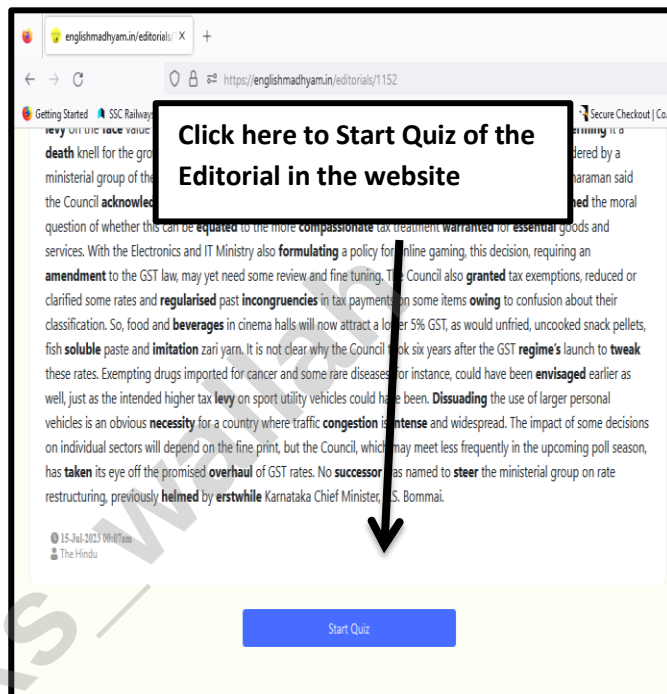
Summary of the Editorial

1. Industrial slowdown: India's Index of Industrial Production (IIP) growth fell to a 10-month low of 1.5% in June 2025, primarily due to declines in mining and electricity output.
2. Mining contraction: Mining activity shrank by 8.7% compared to 10.3% growth in June 2024.
3. Electricity output dip: Electricity generation declined by 2.6%, contrasting with 8.6% growth in the same month last year.
4. Monsoon disruption: An early and erratic southwest monsoon caused severe waterlogging in mining regions such as Odisha, Jharkhand, and West Bengal.
5. Jharkhand rainfall imbalance: Jharkhand saw excess rainfall overall (504.8 mm vs. 307 mm normal), but five districts still faced rain deficiency, showing uneven distribution.
6. Infrastructure damage: Waterlogging damaged power infrastructure and disrupted supply chains, adding to the slowdown in industrial output.
7. Subdued industrial growth: Overall industrial output rose just 3.9% in June 2025, marginally better than 3.5% a year ago.
8. Power demand down: Weakened industrial activity led to lower power demand, reinforcing the electricity sector's decline.
9. Dependence on government spending: Growth in capital (3.5%), intermediate (5.5%), and infrastructure goods (7.2%) output depended heavily on government infrastructure spending.
10. Manufacturing's key role: Manufacturing holds the majority weight in the IIP (about 78%), though mining and power contribute significantly.
11. Climate ignored in data narratives: Official economic narratives rarely link climate events to disruptions in output or GDP growth.
12. RBI and Ministry framing: Economic underperformance is often attributed to supply chain issues, high base effects, or consumption contraction, not climate.
13. Global contrast: Institutions like the ECB and Bank of England have started integrating climate risk into economic and financial assessments, unlike India.
14. Climate attribution challenges: Establishing direct links between events like mine flooding and climate change is complex and politically sensitive.
15. Call for systemic change: The editorial emphasizes that India must begin incorporating climate attribution into macroeconomic metrics like the IIP and GDP for realistic policymaking.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



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